



YOU ARE **39 WEEKS EXACTLY**
7 days to go...

YOUR BABY TODAY

This baby can easily be seen at this late stage in the pregnancy because there is ample amniotic fluid present. The amount of amniotic fluid at this point is still extremely variable, but it is usually in the region of 18 fl oz (0.5 liter).

“Use this time in the run-up to labor to get your partner fully up to speed on how they can help you on the big day.”

It's a good idea to prepare your partner in advance, and figure out what may help the proceedings once labor does begin. If you're planning on listening to music during labor, laboring in a tub, or walking around, inform your partner ahead of time what you think you'll expect from him.

Ask your partner to practice some massage strokes, and teach him how to do them (see [Reflexology](#)). Some women can't bear to be touched during labor, but others find it helpful to have their back, or even just their hands and feet, massaged. You won't really know what works for you until you're in labor but practicing massage now won't hurt.

If your partner has been going to prenatal classes with you, they will be familiar with the breathing and relaxation techniques so practice these together and, if necessary, get advice from your doctor about techniques.

It may be helpful for your partner to speak to friends or relatives who have recently had a baby. Hearing the experiences of others and learning some do's and don'ts of being a birth partner might be useful.